

Cindy Hsu

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Portfolio: <https://cindyhsugit.github.io/playground/>

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GitHub: <https://github.com/cindyhsugit>

Professional Summary

Junior AI engineer transitioning from a senior iOS engineering background at StubHub, Mercari, and Udemy. Built and deployed a containerized FastAPI chatbot integrating the OpenAI API, then extended it with a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline using FAISS vector search to ground responses in custom documents. Comfortable debugging real cross-environment issues (dependency conflicts, git history management) and applying production engineering habits — version control, testing, API design — to a new AI/ML stack.

Core Skills

Python, FastAPI, OpenAI API, RAG pipelines (FAISS, vector embeddings), Docker, Git & GitHub, REST APIs, pytest, cloud deployment (Render), environment variable & secrets management, prompt engineering, JSON, command line

Projects

AI Chatbot with RAG — FastAPI, OpenAI API, FAISS, Docker, Render

Code: <https://github.com/cindyhsugit/ai-chatbot-fastapi-with-rag>

- Built and deployed a containerized FastAPI chatbot integrating the OpenAI API, live on a public URL via Render.
- Extended the system with a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipeline: chunked source documents, generated OpenAI embeddings, and used FAISS for vector similarity search to ground responses in custom content.
- Verified retrieval correctness through adversarial testing — injecting fabricated facts into source documents to confirm answers came from retrieved context, not model pretraining.
- Resolved real cross-environment issues: a Python version mismatch breaking the Docker build, missing dependencies, and secure credential handling via environment variables across local, containerized, and production environments.
- Version-controlled with Git, including resolving a diverged branch and merge conflict during a history cleanup; wrote unit/integration tests for API endpoints using pytest and TestClient.

Experience

Senior iOS Developer

StubHub, San Francisco | March 2017 – May 2019

- Developed new features for different iOS versions, share extensions, widgets, and public/private libraries.
- Enhanced UI behavior for video/audio call states and responsive settings across iPad and iPhone.
- Improved localization support, increasing non-English speaking users by 300%.
- Worked closely with product, design, and QA teams to deliver new features.

Senior iOS Developer

Udemy, San Francisco | April 2015 – February 2017

- Worked closely with product and design teams to implement features for TV and Apple Watch prototypes.
- Handled build and release processes while collaborating with QA overseas.
- Translated the codebase to Swift and increased Swift usage across the project.
- Maintained core data models and adapted component design patterns.

Senior iOS Developer

Mercari, San Francisco | September 2014 – April 2015

- Worked with the Japan team to maintain code consistency and support new feature development.
- Translated code and comments to Japanese and established code standards across teams.
- Tested U.S. and Japan app versions and supported localization testing in English and Japanese.

Education

M.S. Computer Science — University of Southern California

B.S. Computer Science — Iowa State University